

Linchen Zhang

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EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego

San Diego, CA

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

Sep 2021 – Jun 2027 (Expected)

Cornell University

Ithaca, NY

B.A. in Computer Science, Economics (Magna Cum Laude), and Mathematics

Aug 2017 – May 2021

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Microeconomic Theory, Behavioral and Experimental Economics

WORKING PAPERS

Recognizing Dominance through Local Improvement (*Job Market Paper*)

- Proposes a new simplicity concept through local comparison: a mechanism is locally improvement solvable if, starting from any strategy, repeatedly replacing it with an improving neighbor strategy leads to a dominant strategy.
- Draft available upon request.

Market Order Mechanisms (with [Ben Brooks](#) and [Songzi Du](#))

- If the market order mechanisms satisfy vanishing price impact and vanishing span, they can guarantee competitive outcomes in the large, regardless of information structures and equilibria.

Coarse Revenue Guarantee in First Price Auction and Beyond

- Characterized the worst-case revenue in the first-price auction over all Bayes coarse correlated equilibria.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Conditional Dominance and Rationalizability with Information-Based Continuation Reasoning (with [Joel Watson](#))

- Draft coming soon!

Strategic Obliviousness (with [Emanuel Vespa](#) and [Andreas Ziegler](#))

- Current stage: Collecting third round of data.

PROFESSIONAL / ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

Academic Presentations

2026: Econometric Society Asian-China Meeting, Southwest Economics Theory Conference, Asian School in Theory, UCLA Student Theory Conference, UCSD TBE Workshop

2025: 36th Stony Brook Game Theory Conference, Caltech Student Theory Conference, UCSD TBE Workshop

2024: EC'24 (poster), 35th Stony Brook Game Theory Conference, GAIMSS'24, UCSD TBE Workshop

Discussions and Service

2026: Program Committee, ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC)

2026: Panelist, Virtual Seminars in Economic Theory, on Lea Nagel's talk "Designing Simpler Mechanisms: Transparency and As-If Dominance"

AWARDS / FELLOWSHIPS

Clive Granger Research Fellowship, UC San Diego
awarded for the most promising graduate student research 2025

Summer Research Fellowship, UC San Diego 2022, 2023

Regents Fellowship, UC San Diego 2021

Honorable Mention, Mathematical Contest in Modeling (MCM) 2019

Top 500, William Lowell Putnam Mathematical Competition 2018

Omicron Delta Epsilon (International Economics Honor Society), Cornell University

Dean's List (All semesters), Cornell University 2017 – 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record at UC San Diego

ECON 5: Data Analysis in Social Science *Fall 2024, Fall 2025*

Teaching Assistant at UC San Diego

ECON 1: Principles of Microeconomics *Fall 2022, Fall 2023*

ECON 4: Financial Accounting *Winter 2023, Spring 2024*

ECON 5: Data Analysis in Social Science *Spring 2025*

ECON 100B: Microeconomics B *Winter 2024, Winter 2026*

ECON 149: Market Design *Winter 2024, Winter 2025*

ECON 173B: Corporate Finance *Spring 2023*

SKILLS / OTHER INFO

- **Programming:** Python, STATA, MATLAB, R, $\LaTeX$
- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (proficient)

REFERENCES

Professor Songzi Du (Chair)

Department of Economics, UC San Diego
sodu@ucsd.edu

Professor Aram Grigoryan

Department of Economics, UC San Diego
a2grigoryan@ucsd.edu

Professor Joel Watson

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jwatson@ucsd.edu

Professor Emanuel Vespa

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